BUDGET COMMITTEE MEETING – Thursday March 12, 2026
9:00 a.m. – Anne Basker Auditorium
600 N.W. Sixth Street, Grants Pass, OR 97526

Budget Committee: Marc Kirby, Chad Hansen – arrived 9:01 a.m., Ron Smith, Colene Martin, Gary Richardson; Kassie Austin, Recorder
Budget Officer: Ruth Nelson, Finance Director

The committee recited the Pledge of Allegiance.

1) **Open Meeting – Ron Smith, Chair, Board of County Commissioners**
   Commissioner Ron opened the meeting at 9:00 a.m.
2) **Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest**
   All members declared that there is not a conflict of interest on today's agenda.
3) **Establish new Chair and Vice-Chair for the Budget Committee**
   Ron Smith nominated Colene Martin as the chair of the budget committee. Gary Richardson seconded the nomination. Marc Kirby nominated Chad Hansen as the Chair, and Mr. Hansen seconded the nomination. After discussion, Mr. Hansen declared that he supports Ms. Martin as Chair. Upon roll call; Mr. Kirby – no, Mr. Hansen -yes, Mr. Richardson - yes, Ms. Martin - yes, and Mr. Smith - yes. Nomination carried 4-1.
   Ms. Martin nominated Mr. Hansen as the Vice-Chair of the budget committee, and Mr. Richardson seconded the nomination. Upon roll call, Mr. Kirby – yes, Mr. Hansen – yes, Mr. Richardson – yes, Ms. Martin - yes, and Mr. Smith – yes. Nomination carried 5-0.
4) **Budget Officer presents the Fiscal Year 2025-26 Supplemental Budget**
   Ruth Nelson, Budget Officer, presented the **Supplemental Budget Fiscal Year 2025-2026 (Exhibit 1)** to the Budget Committee. Mike McGlaughlin, Josephine County Firewise Coordinator, explained the funding for the coordinator in previous years, and title III funds, and how the county serves 33 communities within the county. Ryan Johnson, Facilities Director, explained that the communication department has in the past been a stand-alone department, but through attrition, Facilities has absorbed the department, and the county is down to one employee that is familiar with the radio and communications system. The department is requesting an additional employee to be trained before the communications specialist retires. James Black, Planning Director, explained his department's request for two additional planners for his department. Michelle Shaw, Human Resources Director, explained the additional budget request, as there has been an ongoing workers compensation settlement, and costs have incurred.
5) **Public Comment** *(limit of three minutes each)*
   None heard.
6) **Deliberate on Supplemental Budget**
   The budget committee deliberated on the supplemental budget, and asked Ms. Nelson clarifying questions.
7) **Motion to Approve Supplemental Budget**
   Mr. Hansen moved that the four department requests get voted on individually. The motion was seconded by Mr. Kirby. Upon Roll Call, , Mr. Kirby – yes, Mr. Hansen - yes, Mr. Richardson – yes, Mrs. Martin – yes, Mr. Smith – no. Motion carried 4-1.

   Mr. Richardson moved that the budget committee approve the Emergency Management Firewise Program in the amount of $330,000.00 and increase one (1) additional FTE. The motion was seconded by Mr. Smith. Upon Roll Call, Mr. Kirby – no, Mr. Hansen - no, Mr. Richardson – yes, Mrs. Martin – yes, Mr. Smith – yes. Motion carried 5-0.

   Mr. Richardson moved that the budget committee approve the contingency use of $50,000.00 to Planning with the addition of two (2) new FTE's. The motion was seconded by Mr. Smith. Upon Roll Call, Mr. Kirby – no, Mr. Hansen - no, Mr. Richardson – yes, Mrs. Martin – yes, Mr. Smith – yes. Motion did not carry 3-2.

Mr. Smith moved that the budget committee approve the facilities request for a $20,000.00 contingency fund use with the addition of one (1) FTE. The motion was seconded by Mr. Richardson. Upon Roll Call, Mr. Kirby –no, Mr. Hansen - no, Mr. Richardson – yes, Mrs. Martin – yes, Mr. Smith – yes. Motion did not carry 3-2.

Mr. Smith moved that the budget committee approve the Human Resources us of the contingency fund in the amount of $160,000.00. The motion was seconded by Mr. Richardson. Upon Roll Call, Mr. Kirby – no, Mr. Hansen - no, Mr. Richardson – yes, Mrs. Martin – yes, Mr. Smith – yes. Motion carried did not carry 3-2.

8) Adjourn

The meeting adjourned at 10:12 a.m.

Exhibit 1 – Budget Message FY 2026

Budget Committee
Meeting
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Exhibit 1

Supplemental Budget FY 2026

March 12, 2026

JOSEPHINE COUNTY

Supplemental Budget Process

- The method to amend the budget after adoption
- The Budget Committee is required per the County charter
- The supplemental budget was made available on the County website this past Monday.
- The opportunity for public testimony will be provided at this meeting.

Budget Adjustments

- Emergency Management (Firewise) - $330K
  - $240K OSFM CWRR grant to provide assistance to homeowners to create defensible space – extension has been requested
  - $90K Title III funds for support staff to carryout the grant up to 1 FTE
  - These funds will not be fully spent this fiscal year, but will be carried forward to next fiscal year

Budget Adjustments

- Community Development (Planning) - $50K
  - Use of contingency to add 2 FTE for remainder of FY
  - Needed to address backlog in the Planning department and due to the new marijuana annual compliance ordinance
  - Future cost will be about $200K per year
  - Will be offset by new marijuana annual compliance late fees once adopted

Budget Adjustments

- Facilities - $20K
  - Use of contingency to add 1 FTE for the remainder of FY
  - Needed back up Communications System Assistant

- Insurance Reserve
  - Contingency use of $160K to cover cost of prior year workers comp claim

Total Budget Adjustments

- The total increase to the 2025-26 County budget is $90K and 4 FTE.
- $90K is the increase to the "footprint of the budget" because contingency is being used.
- After Budget Committee approval the BCC will adopt after a public hearing.
- The Supplemental Budget hearing and adoption is tentatively scheduled for March 25th at 9:00 AM.

Questions?